

of the late Civil War made frontal assaults deadly, and deprived both sides of the freedom to maneuver. The Civil War thus drifted into a tactical stalemate decided by attrition.



Union trenches at Vicksburg

During sieges, troops dug elaborate trench systems that discouraged attack. Although earthworks were rarely as salubrious as those shown here, once in a trench a soldier was often reluctant to leave it.